3.11 Pulmonary Embolism*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I suddenly could not breathe and my chest hurts." **Objective** • SpO_2 87% • HR 124/min, RR 32/min • Anxious and sweating	**ACTUAL** Impaired gas exchange related to ventilation–perfusion mismatch as evidenced by sudden dyspnea, hypoxemia and tachycardia.	• SpO_2 94% or more within 6 hours.	• Give oxygen as prescribed. • Sit her in high Fowler. • Keep SpO_2, ECG and vital signs on continuous monitoring. • Give anticoagulant or thrombolytic therapy as prescribed. • Prepare her for CT pulmonary angiography.	• Met at target SpO_2 with less dyspnea.
Subjective • "I feel I am going to die." **Objective** • Restless • Trembling	**ACTUAL** Excessive fear related to sudden dyspnea and chest pain as evidenced by expressed fear and restlessness.	• Reports less fear within 2 hours.	• Stay with her. • Explain each step briefly and calmly. • Give analgesia as prescribed.	• Achieved when she is calmer.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On heparin or another anticoagulant	**RISK** Risk for excessive bleeding as evidenced by risk factors: anticoagulant or thrombolytic therapy.	• No bleeding; clotting results within the therapeutic range.	• Follow aPTT, anti-Xa or INR as ordered. • Look for bleeding from gums, in urine and stool, and at puncture sites. • Avoid IM injections. • Make sure the reversal agent is available, per policy.	• Outcome reached if no bleeding occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [37], [45], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.